8.7 WRITING LESSONS 9–10

OVERVIEW

Duration: 40+40 minutes

Objectives:
- Can identify the main topic and related ideas in a structured text (P) (GSE 49 – B1).
- Can contrast two ideas in simple connected text using a range of common linking words/phrases (e.g. *but*, *although*, *on the other hand*) (P) (GSE 53 – B1+).
- Can write simple informal emails/letters and online postings giving news or opinions (P) (GSE 46 – B1).

Resources:
- SB pp. 110–111
- TB: Culture notes p. 175; Photocopiable Resource 44 pp. 210, 263
- WB pp. 110–111
- Online resources: Teacher's Resources, Sample answer for Exercise 7

LESSON 9

WARM-UP | 5–6 minutes

(T–S, S–T) Exercise 1. Refer Ss to the online forum page and read the question aloud. Elicit ideas from different Ss and have a brief class discussion. Then give Ss 1 minute to read the post. When they have finished, ask whether they agree or disagree with the views expressed. Elicit ideas from different Ss with reasons why.

TIP

See Culture notes in TB p. 175 for information about the blue light of smartphones.

PRACTICE | 31–33 minutes

1 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 2. Tell them to complete the WRITING FOCUS with the linkers in purple in the article in Exercise 1. Give Ss 1–2 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Go through the WRITING FOCUS with the class and make sure Ss understand the phrases which can be used while giving an opinion in a piece of writing. Wherever possible, suggest alternative linkers and phrases to replace the ones given there. Drill the linkers and phrases as a whole class and with random individuals if necessary.

2 (S–S, T–S, S–T) Ss do Exercise 3 individually. Give them 2 minutes to complete the reader's comment on the post in Exercise 1 with appropriate phrases and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check.

3 (T–S, S–T) Refer Ss to Exercise 4. Read through the summary of opinions expressed by both writers. Give Ss 2 minutes to answer the questions. When they have finished, elicit the answers for questions 1 and 2 and check. Then ask individual Ss to say who they agree with, giving reasons why and have a brief class discussion.

4 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 5. Give them 2–3 minutes to complete the examples in the LANGUAGE FOCUS with the underlined sentences in the text in Exercise 1 and then to check their answers in pairs. When they are ready, elicit the answers and check. Then go through the LANGUAGE FOCUS with the class. Make sure Ss understand different structures with *make* and how they differ in meaning. Either give some examples or ask Ss to come up with some.

5 (S–S, T–S, S–T) Ss do Exercise 6 individually. Give them 3 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Elicit which sentences are true for Ss. Encourage them to give as much detail as possible in their answers.

LESSON 10

PRODUCTION | 38 minutes

1 (T–S, S–T) Refer Ss to Exercise 7. Give them 2 minutes to read quickly through the text and the writing task and underline the key words. Elicit key words from Ss. Then read through the information Ss should include and check understanding. Give Ss 15 minutes to write a reader's comment including this information. Remind Ss to use the WRITING FOCUS and the LANGUAGE FOCUS boxes to help them. Also, tell them that they can use Daisy's comment in Exercise 3 as a model for their writing. As they do this, walk around monitoring, supporting and taking notes of any problems.

2 (S–S) When they have finished writing, tell Ss to self-check their comments.

3 (S–S) Then put Ss in pairs and tell them to swap comments. Ss should now check if their partner's comment includes all the information and if everything is clear and then they give it back.

4 (S–S) Give Ss another 5 minutes to make changes to their comments based on the feedback they got from their partner before handing them in for your evaluation and feedback. Finally, do a class feedback session.

5 (T–S, S–T) Give Ss a model text for Exercise 7 and ask them to compare it with their own. Alternatively, this could be omitted or could be done in a following lesson if you are short of time.

HOMEWORK

Give Ss WB pp. 110–111 as homework.

CONTINGENCY PLAN

Refer to TB p. 110 for extra activities.